



notebooks posed the risk of actually going up in smoke, the rest of the vendors claim to have recalled batteries to placate their concerned customers.

Now, it seems that three of these companies—Toshiba, Hitachi and Fujitsu—are concerned about the damage the recall might have done to their brand image, and might consider claiming damages from Sony to tide over the cost of the recall and the sales they might have lost due to said brand damage. As of this writing, there is no news to indicate that the rest of the companies have any such intentions. It is estimated that Sony will have to shell out between \$340 million and \$510 million in just replacement costs—an uncomfortable expense given their current financial situation. Add to that the possible costs of lawsuit settlements, and we might see that discomfort turn quite painful. Sony hasn't been contacted to foot the costs yet, and we still don't know how they intend to respond if they are.

However, there is hope for the company. The only "spectacular" examples of the batteries' flaws have been seen in Dell and Apple—none of the above companies' products were in the news for even a puff, let alone fires. Moreover, all news reports have clearly fingered Sony as the root cause, noting that there was nothing really wrong with any of the laptops otherwise. If the matter does go to court then, they're going to have a tough time convincing judge and jury that their image was truly sullied by the recall.

TRANSMETA WAKES UP

Intel Sued For Billions

Transmeta, the company famous for creating the Crusoe (for latecomers, that's their low-power consuming processor for laptops and palmtops),

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